Casting Rules

Volume 02 — locked in on top of Volume 01. These rules apply to every chapter from April 28, 2006 onward.

Rule 1 — Real Actors Keep Their Roles

Every MCU character keeps the real-life actor who played them, **except for the ten roles listed in Rule 2**. They are cast in the story through realistic Hollywood channels: auditions, agents, screen tests, negotiations and press leaks.

Rule 2 — The Ten Roles for Fictional Actors

#	Role	Character (comic-accurate)	Actor
1	Iron Man	Tony Stark	Fictional (you'll create)
2	Hulk	Bruce Banner / Hulk	Fictional (you'll create)
3	Captain America	Steve Rogers	Fictional (you'll create)
4	Ant-Man	Hank Pym *(founding Avenger)*	Fictional (you'll create)
5	Wasp	Janet van Dyne *(founding Avenger)*	Fictional (you'll create)
6	Black Widow	Natasha Romanoff	Fictional (you'll create)
7	Thor	**Thor, daughter of Odin — always female**	Fictional, female
8	Hawkeye	**Claire Barton — always female**	Fictional, female
9	Scarlet Witch	Wanda Maximoff	Fictional (you'll create)
10	Pepper Potts	Virginia "Pepper" Potts	Fictional (you'll create)

Rule 3 — Thor and Hawkeye Have Always Been Women

- **No legacy and no passing the torch.** Thor has always been Odin's daughter, and Hawkeye has always been Claire Barton. There was never a male version.
- **Everything else stays comic-accurate.** Thor is the God of Thunder, Loki is her adopted brother, she is worthy of Mjolnir, and she has full godly power with no nerfs. Claire Barton's history follows Clint's from the comics: the carnival, Trick Shot and the Swordsman, her start as a reformed criminal, and joining the Avengers in *Avengers* #16 (1965).
- **In the real-world story,** this is a creative decision Marvel Studios makes. Trade press, fans and message boards react to it the way they really would have in 2006 and 2007.

Rule 4 — Ages and Availability of Real Actors

Real actors are cast at a believable moment in their real careers, with their real ages. Ages on April 28, 2006:

Actor	MCU role	Born	Age (4/28/06)
Samuel L. Jackson	Nick Fury	Dec 21, 1948	57
Anthony Hopkins	Odin	Dec 31, 1937	68
Jeff Bridges	Obadiah Stane	Dec 4, 1949	56
Hugo Weaving	Red Skull	Apr 4, 1960	46
Clark Gregg	Phil Coulson	Apr 2, 1962	44
Josh Brolin	Thanos	Feb 12, 1968	38

Actor	MCU role	Born	Age (4/28/06)
Paul Bettany	Vision	May 27, 1971	34
Chadwick Boseman	Black Panther	Nov 29, 1976	29
Benedict Cumberbatch	Doctor Strange	July 19, 1976	29
Anthony Mackie	Falcon	Sept 23, 1978	27
Chris Pratt	Star-Lord	June 21, 1979	26
Tom Hiddleston	Loki	Feb 9, 1981	25
Hayley Atwell	Peggy Carter	Apr 5, 1982	24
Sebastian Stan	Bucky Barnes	Aug 13, 1982	23
Tom Holland	Spider-Man	June 1, 1996	9

A sample, not the full list. Every real actor gets added to the age register the first time they appear.

Confirmed Decisions

You answered these on Volume 02's open questions. They are now locked canon.

#	Topic	Locked decision
1	Thor's name	**Thor**, daughter of Odin and Frigga. Her formal Asgardian name is "Thor Odinsdottir."
2	Ant-Man and Wasp	**Hank Pym and Janet van Dyne**, founding Avengers from *Avengers* #1 (1963), both played by fictional actors. Scott Lang comes later as the second Ant-Man, played by his real actor, Paul Rudd.
3	Roles with more than one real actor	The actor most identified with the role: **Josh Brolin** as Thanos and **William Hurt** as Thunderbolt Ross. Howard Stark keeps both actors, **Dominic Cooper** when young and **John Slattery** when older.
3a	**Exception: Rhodey**	Rhodey keeps his **real casting history**. **Terrence Howard** (born March 11, 1969; 37 today) plays him in *Iron Man*. **Don Cheadle** (born November 29, 1964; 41 today) replaces him from *Iron Man 2* on. The recast plays out in the real-world story as it did in real life: contract talks, trade headlines and fan reaction.
4	Characters never played in the MCU	Keep the actor most identified with the role, for example **Hugh Jackman** as Wolverine.
5	Real-life tragedies	Real history stays the same. Events like Chadwick Boseman's death in August 2020 will happen, and I'll handle them respectfully, the way real life did.
6	Claire Barton's relationships	Still open. We'll decide when Hawkeye's storyline reaches that point.